



SESSION 1 — COACH

Our Identity

Who are we as a team?

COACH OBJECTIVE

Coaches help the team form a shared identity. Players name values that matter to them personally and as a team, and connect these to their behavior on and off the court.

COACH NOTE

Ask open questions rather than providing answers. Your role is facilitator: make sure every player gets to speak. Note the most frequently mentioned values — these will become the foundation of the culture agreements.

ACTIVITIES**1 Check-in: one word**

⌚ 5 min

Ask each player: "Name one word that describes you as an athlete." Write all words on the board. Look for clusters.

2 Our core values

⌚ 15 min

Let the team work in pairs to choose 3 values they want to embody as a team. Plenary exchange: which values come up most? Choose 3–5 team values together.

3 Fill in the identity card

⌚ 10 min

Players individually complete the identity card: "As a team we are... We believe in... We choose to..."

NOTES



DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Why did you choose these values?
- What does a player look like who lives these values every day?
- What changes if everyone does this?

CLOSING

Summarize the 3–5 chosen team values and post or write them on a large sheet. Tell the group: "This is who we are — this becomes our foundation for the rest of the season."

NOTES

"Culture is not just one aspect of the game — it is the game."

— Lou Gerstner